

Tesla Inc

SPCX-TSLA Combination Thoughts: Strategically Coherent; Regulatory Challenges and SPCX Acquisition Currency Key to Watch

We see the [possibility of a SpaceX-Tesla](#) combination as strategically coherent on paper, allowing CEO Musk to unify vision, mission, and engineering leadership across both platforms. This includes vertical integration across AI, robotics, energy, transportation, & space, anchored by Terafab & a combined ~\$28.5T TAM narrative on the SPCX side (see [JPM initiation](#) this morning). In addition, SPCX's record IPO furnishes a high-value acquisition currency. That said, we think recent press reports understate the practical bottleneck of securing multi-jurisdictional regulatory approvals, especially in markets where TSLA has meaningful manufacturing exposure. China could be a particular hurdle given the potential national security sensitivities created by SPCX's defense/U.S. government ties, the absence of Starlink approval in China, and TSLA's large, profitable China manufacturing footprint – key dynamics that are at odds with each other. Other hurdles include governance/voting symmetry given Musk controls ~85% of SPCX voting power but only 20% of TSLA's, as well as the perception that a combination would be a SPCX-led acquisition rather than a merger of equals, particularly in the context of recent signs of a turnaround in TSLA's fundamentals with strong [2Q26 deliveries](#) and FSD approvals/robotaxi roll-outs gathering pace (see our [robotaxi](#) and [TSLA](#) deep-dives). Net-net, we would monitor SPCX acquisition currency, regulatory landscape, and Musk's TSLA voting power as catalysts to nearing a potential combination.

The case for a combination: Operational integration between the two entities is already deep, which would help facilitate an eventual combination. The companies share engineering talent, AI infrastructure, the \$55B-119B Terafab chip facility in Texas, and, most importantly, in our view, Elon Musk's leadership and engineering philosophy. The commercial linkages are also concrete—SPCX has purchased TSLA Megapack batteries & Cybertrucks, while TSLA invested \$2B in xAI (now part of SPCX). The shared AI ambition is, in our view, the potential strategic glue. SPCX allocated 76% of its \$10.1B 1Q26 capex to AI, and TSLA plans ~\$25B of capex in 2026 focused on AI/robotics/chips. Layered atop this is Musk's well-documented consolidation track record & the end thesis of unifying the AI ecosystem under a single corporate roof. Importantly, [President Gwynne Shotwell recently acknowledged the potential synergies and did not rule out a future combination](#), noting it “might make Elon's life a little easier.” We highlight two potentially enabling catalysts in particular. First, SPCX's record \$1.77T IPO (priced at \$135/share, ~\$85B raised) furnishes a high-value acquisition currency. Second, Musk's move to lift his TSLA voting stake to ~20% (via exercise of his 2018 award) meaningfully increases his control.

The case against/potential hurdles: Against this, we flag a set of structural impediments that, in our view, could complicate such a move. Regulatory scrutiny is a gating item, with SPCX's government contracts (NASA/Pentagon) and TSLA's China exposure likely inviting antitrust/national-security review. TSLA has historically managed this balance within its existing structure, maintaining a

Neutral

TSLA, TSLA US
Price (06 Jul 26):\$419.77

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sizeable wholly owned footprint as a non-Chinese OEM, and advancing FSD, so there could be an eventual pathway through approvals. The other hurdle is governance/voting asymmetry. Musk controls ~85% of SPCX voting power but only ~20% of TSLA's, complicating potential deal dynamics & raising possible dilution/governance concerns for minority TSLA holders. In addition, SPCX's market cap (~\$2.2T) exceeds TSLA's (\$1.4T), which could imply an acquisition of TSLA by SPCX rather than a merger of equals – after challenges in 2025, fundamentals are turning a corner at TSLA with a [strong 2Q deliveries print](#) and pickup in FSD approval and robotaxi/Cybercab roll-outs.

Potential deal structures: We see four primary potential paths for a SPCX-TSLA combination: 1) An all-stock, SPCX-led acquisition of TSLA is most likely, w/SPCX issuing new shares at a fixed conversion ratio & modest premium—a structure we believe likely best reconciles the valuation gap while avoiding a large cash outlay; 2) NewCo/HoldCo roll-up—both entities folding into a newly formed parent—could offer cleaner “merger of equals” optics & ease minority-holder concerns, though we'd expect exchange ratios to still likely skew toward SPCX in such a scenario; 3) A cash-and-stock hybrid could deliver a sharper premium & accelerate approval, but we view it as less likely near term since any cash outlay would likely further strain leverage/FCF against SPCX's AI-heavy capex; and 4) A phased/partial combination could de-risk the likely regulatory & governance hurdles & provide a longer runway toward what we think may ultimately be an all but inevitable combination. Across potential alternatives, we continue to flag conversion ratio/premium, regulatory clearance, & dual board/shareholder approval as the gating items to watch.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 06 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
SpaceX(SPCX/\$160.42/OW)

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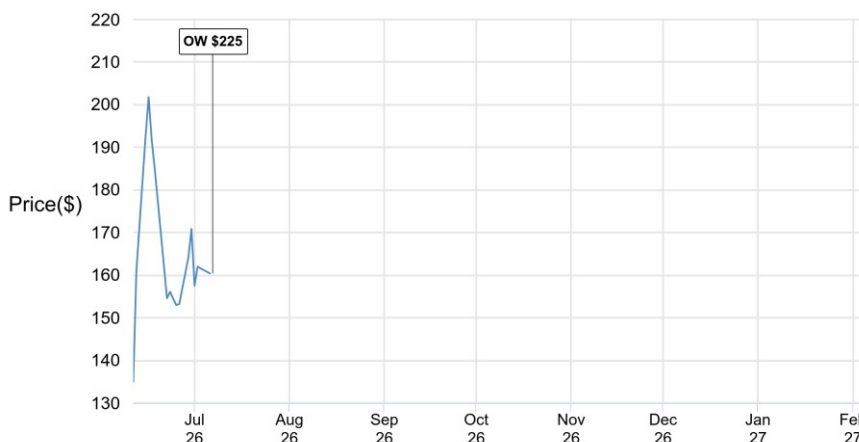
Tesla Inc (TSLA, TSLA US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
03-Oct-23	UW	251.60	135
26-Jan-24	UW	182.63	130
03-Apr-24	UW	166.63	115
03-Oct-24	UW	249.02	130
24-Oct-24	UW	213.65	135
12-Mar-25	UW	230.58	120
23-Apr-25	UW	237.97	115
03-Oct-25	UW	436.00	150
29-Jan-26	UW	431.46	145
05-Jun-26	N	418.45	475

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Aug 09, 2010. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

SpaceX (SPCX, SPCX US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
07-Jul-26	OW	160.42	225

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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